

John Campbell Thomas

Software Studio Founder · AI Engineer · USCG Master Captain

“Production AI on Anthropic Claude. Eight apps live on the App Store. Built in Honolulu, shipped worldwide.”

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8

IOS APPS LIVE

~48

PRODUCTION SERVICES

2,300+

Q AI EVAL BANK

100T

USCG MASTER

SUMMARY

Operator-engineer running a one-person software studio in Honolulu that ships AI-native web and iOS products on the Anthropic Claude API — eight apps live on the App Store and ~48 production services on one box, spanning compliance SaaS, a statewide permit/parcel data platform, an iOS LiDAR estimator, and a multi-agent evaluation loop over a 2,300-question bank. Ten years operating real businesses before writing first production code: 100-ton USCG Master, Alaskan timber-frame and Honolulu finish carpentry, commercial dive ops, alpine fleet management. A trades-fluent founder shipping production AI is a rare profile — I want forward-deployed, founding-engineer, or developer-advocate roles where that overlap is the moat.

IN THE CODE

AI-Native Studio

Ikena Design & Build, LLC. AI-native products on Claude, eight live on the App Store. Next.js, FastAPI, Postgres, Swift, Cloudflare, Vultr.

ON THE WATER

USCG Master 100T

1,000+ sea days, Alaska to Hawaii. Towing, salvage, charter, commercial dive, sail.

ON THE GROUND

Operator-Founder

Multi-company P&L. Crews of 10+ in maritime and alpine ops. Built and ran an LLC end-to-end.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE · SOFTWARE

Founder & Engineer — Ikena Design & Build, LLC

2024 — CURRENT

Honolulu, Hawaii · [ikenagroup.com](https://www.ikenagroup.com)

One-person software studio shipping AI-native web and iOS products on Anthropic Claude — eight apps live on the App Store and ~48 production services as of July 2026.

Binnacle School — Maritime license-exam SaaS on a 2,300-question bank, QC'd by a multi-agent Claude review-then-judge pipeline. An "explain-my-mistake" tutor grounds Claude on the student's exact wrong answer and cites the governing COLREGS/CFR rule; spaced repetition, Stripe Pro tier, companion iOS app live.

Binnacle AI — Multi-tenant maritime crew-compliance SaaS. [binnacleai.com](https://www.binnacleai.com). Credential tracking (MMC / TWIC / medical / STCW), expiration flagging, sea-service parsing, CFR Part 10/11 eligibility, and Claude Vision document classification. Live token-gated demo with watermarked sessions.

Āina Atlas — Statewide Hawaii permit / parcel / zoning / FEMA data platform: 384,262 TMK parcels across all four counties unified into one schema. Address or TMK resolves to a Claude-written property brief with county-permit deep links. Live web + API; iOS app on the App Store.

ProBuildCalc — Native iOS LiDAR estimator. Apple RoomPlan + ARKit mesh + Object Capture; scan metrics feed a Claude Sonnet call that returns a priced estimate. Live on the App Store.

Clearspar — Aviation Part 135 charter-ops SaaS. Self-blocking 14 CFR 135.267 duty/rest, weight-and-balance, and runway-performance gates that hash-chain each violation into a tamper-evident audit ledger; 72 passing vitest tests; batched CI deploys.

BlueWave Projects — Multi-tenant SaaS for general contractors. AI scope generation, client portal, e-sign (DocuSeal), Stripe billing, change orders. Sole engineer, designer, and operator. Next.js, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Claude.

Production AI: hand-rolled a raw-HTTP Claude integration (no SDK) with env-var model selection and Haiku/Sonnet cost-metered routing; patterns for inline-generative, async, classification, and tool-using-agent loops; a multi-agent review-then-judge eval loop over a 2,300-question bank, with concurrency caps and backoff after hitting rate limits at scale.

`next.js` · `react` · `astro` · `fastapi` · `postgres` · `anthropic-claude` (`haiku/sonnet/opus`) · `swift` · `swiftui` · `roomplan` · `cloudflare` (`pages/workers/email`) · `vultr` · `stripe` · `docuseal` · `resend`

TECHNICAL STACK

LANGUAGES	TypeScript · Python · Swift · SQL · Bash	FRONTEND	Next.js · React · Astro · Tailwind · MapLibre GL
BACKEND	FastAPI · Node · PostgreSQL · Redis	AI	Anthropic Claude (raw-HTTP, no SDK) · Multi-agent eval · Prompt caching · Tool-use · Streaming
IOS	Swift · SwiftUI · RoomPlan · Object Capture · ARKit	INFRA	Cloudflare Pages/Workers · Vultr · Docker · Nginx Proxy Manager
PAYMENTS	Stripe (billing, subs, multi-tier) · DocuSeal · Resend	DEVOPS	GitHub · Cursor · CI auto-deploy · Cloudflare Pages git auto-build
DATA	ArcGIS REST · OSM Overpass · NOAA NDBC · USPS · TMK/parcel data	PATTERNS	Multi-tenant SaaS · Token-gated demos · RAG · Webhooks · Cron pipelines

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE · OPERATIONS & MARITIME

USCG Master Captain · Sales ManagerAPR 2025 — NOV 2025

Ohana Boats Sales & Hawaii Boat Club · Honolulu, HI

- Managed fleet of 12+ private and club vessels at 100% USCG and local regulatory compliance.
- Coordinated maintenance, repairs, and charter scheduling; cut downtime 15% via proactive inspection cadence.
- Trained and supervised deck crews; standardized safety procedures and emergency response drills.

Senior Tow & Salvage Master CaptainAUG 2021 — JUN 2023

Sea Tow International · Seward, AK & San Diego, CA

- Vessel tows, salvage, and marine emergency rescue across Alaskan and Californian waters, in every season and condition.

Founder · Charter Operations · CaptainAPR 2020 — MAY 2024

Fjords Adventures, LLC · Seward, AK

- Built and ran the LLC end-to-end — bookings, marketing, regulatory paperwork, and captain ops, with a clean USCG and national-park compliance record.

Operations Manager · Captain · Lead Mechanic · Dive SupervisorJUN 2021 — AUG 2023

Storm Chasers Shipyard · Seward, AK

- Directed commercial dive operations — underwater construction, hydro-sync lifts, pipelines, offshore structures — and led shipyard crews through vessel projects on time and safely.

MOUNTAIN OPERATIONS

Snowcat Operations Manager · Fuel Distribution ManagerDEC 2018 — APR 2025

Chugach Powder Guides · Girdwood, AK

- Led 10+ operators and maintenance crew; built a culture of safety, efficiency, and teamwork.
- Implemented control measures that cut helicopter charter cancellations, in strict compliance with Alaska heli-cat and environmental regulations.

CERTIFICATIONS & IDENTIFICATION

USCG LICENSES & RATINGS

USCG Master 100-Ton Near Coastal (sail/auxiliary) · Radar Observer · Unlimited Able Seafarer · Unlimited ARPA · Assistance Towing · FCC Marine Radio Operator · Lifeboat Operator · Wiper · Steward's Department (F.H.) · USCG Medical Certification

STCW

STCW II/4 — RFPNW · STCW VI/1 — Basic Training · STCW VI/2 — Survival Craft & Rescue Boats (PSC) · STCW VI/3 — Advanced Firefighting

SAFETY, RESCUE, ID

PADI Rescue Diver · First Aid & CPR · OSHA Hazmat · FEMA Rescue Technician · Various NIMS · UFSAC Firefighter · TWIC · US Passport · Global Entry · 200-Ton Oceans Master / Mate (filed, awaiting return) · VPDS (filed, awaiting return)

EDUCATION

Miami University — Oxford, OH

May 2014 · B.S. Business Marketing · Minor in Naval Science

Activities: Delta Sigma Pi Business Fraternity · Full-time Firefighter / EMT · Airport Manager · Rock Climbing Course Instructor